

CHORDS

LESSON 27

TAKE NOTES AND ADD THEM TO A TRIAD AND YOU GET YOUR NUMBERED CHORDS. THAT'S HOW IT'S SUPPOSED TO WORK. BUT JUST WHEN YOU GET TO THINKING THAT YOU UNDERSTAND THAT, YOU FIND THERE ARE A NUMBER OF

EXCEPTIONS AND SURPRISES INVOLVING THE NUMBER SYSTEM WHEN NAMING CHORDS

C7.....1-3-5-b7

DOMINANT 7

Cmaj7..1-3-5-7

Cm7....1-b3-5-b7

Cm^{maj7}...1-b3-5-7

The DOMINANT 7 CHORD is the most common numbered chord in all styles of Western Music and yet it could be your first point of confusion when it comes to CHORD STRUCTURE. You might think it should go 1-3-5-7 but it doesn't. The number 7 very often means note b7 when naming chords. The DOMINANT 7 is the b7. Think back to the DEGREES OF THE MAJOR DIATONIC SCALE. The V is called the DOMINANT. It is the domain of the V CHORD and so very important. Notice that the 5th MODE, MIXOLYDIAN, is a MAJOR SCALE with a b7. The V CHORD is so often a DOMINANT 7 CHORD that it is often referred to as the $\text{V}7$ CHORD. The chord that actually goes 1-3-5-7 is called a MAJOR 7 CHORD and the abbreviation maj is spelled out in the chord name. A MINOR 7 CHORD is a MINOR TRIAD with the DOMINANT 7. And then there is the rare and interesting MINOR MAJOR 7...a MINOR TRIAD with the MAJOR 7th.

C^{SUS 4}.....1-4-5

C^{SUS 2}.....1-2-5

C7^{SUS 4}....1-4-5-b7

SUSPENSION

SUSPENSION isn't something you add to a TRIAD, it's a way of MODIFYING the TRIAD. A SUSPENSION REPLACES THE 3rd IN THE CHORD. This sets up some interesting TENSIONS that are very commonly used. You FEEL SUSPENDED like the music is restless ...UNRESOLVED. This is the classic meaning of CONSONANCE and DISSONANCE in MUSIC THEORY. A SUS4 is kind of like the "AH-" in "AH-MEN" at the end of the CHURCH HYMN. You don't feel complete and at rest again until the SUSPENDED 4th is released and drops back down to the MAJOR 3rd at "-MEN"...it's point of RESOLUTION and CONSONANCE within a MAJOR CHORD.

C9.....1-3-5-b7-9

C^{add 9}.....1-3-5-9

Cm9....1-b3-5-b7-9

Cmaj9..1-3-5-7-9

C11....1-(X)-5-b7-9-11

Cm11..1-b3-5-b7-(9)-11

C13....1-3-5-b7-(9)-(11)-13

Cm13..1-b3-5-b7-(9)-(11)-13

EXTENDED CHORDS

Add yet another note above 7 and you are talking EXTENDED CHORDS. The first EXTENSION is the 9th. Most all of these have 7 in them. If it contains b7, it is called an EXTENDED DOMINANT CHORD. An ADD9 CHORD is simply a TRIAD with the 9 added to it. The MAJ9 CHORD CONTAINS a MAJ7. The 9 CHORD is common in BLUES.

The next EXTENSION is the 11th. It's like a 4 in the next octave. NOTICE THAT IT RETAINS THE PREVIOUS EXTENSION (the 9). The MAJOR 3rd is usually left out of the 11 CHORD because it clashes with the 11. They have a kind of "otherworldly" sound because they are classic POLYCHORDS ...a chord made up of elements of other chords all "smashed" into one and competing for your ears attention.

THE 13 CHORD is very big in JAZZ, ROCKABILLY and to a lesser extent, BLUES. You have a lot of VOICING options with these chords ...often simply coming down to what's POSSIBLE with your fingers! The 13 CHORD is often played as a DOMINANT 7 CHORD with an added 6th.

NOW YOU KNOW THE CODE. YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO LOOK AT ANY CHORD AND FIGURE OUT WHAT NOTES ARE IN IT. THESE EXAMPLES ARE ALL NOTED AS THEY WOULD APPEAR IN THE KEY OF C.

C.....	MAJOR.....	1 3 5
Cm.....	MINOR.....	1 b3 5
Caug...C+.....	AUGMENTED.....	1 3 #5
Cdim...Co.....	DIMINISHED TRIAD.....	1 b3 b5
Csus2.....	SUSPENDED SECOND.....	1 2 5
Csus4.....	SUSPENDED FOURTH.....	1 4 5
C5.....	5 "POWER CHORD".....	1 5
Cb5.....	FLAT 5.....	1 3 b5
C6.....	SIX.....	1 3 5 6
Cm6.....	MINOR SIX.....	1 b3 5 6
C6/9.....	SIX ADD NINE.....	1 3 5 6 9
Cm6/9.....	MINOR SIX ADD NINE.....	1 b3 5 6 9
Cdim7.....	DIMINISHED 7th CHORD.....	(FULL DIM.) 1 b3 b5 bb7 (6)
C7.....	DOMINANT SEVEN.....	1 3 5 b7
Cm7.....	MINOR SEVEN.....	1 b3 5 b7
Cmaj7.....	MAJOR SEVEN.....	1 3 5 7
C7sus4.....	SEVEN SUSPENDED FOUR.....	1 4 5 b7
Cm/maj7.....	MINOR MAJOR SEVEN.....	1 b3 5 7
C7#5.....	SEVEN SHARP FIVE.....	1 3 #5 b7
C7b5.....	SEVEN FLAT FIVE.....	1 3 b5 b7
Cm7b5...C $\emptyset$	MINOR SEVEN FLAT FIVE.....	(HALF DIM.) 1 b3 b5 b7
C7#5#9.....	SEVEN SHARP FIVE SHARP NINE.....	1 3 #5 b7 #9
C7#5b9.....	SEVEN SHARP FIVE FLAT NINE.....	1 3 #5 b7 b9
C7b5b9.....	SEVEN FLAT FIVE FLAT NINE.....	1 3 b5 b7 b9
C7#9.....	SEVEN SHARP NINE.....	1 3 5 b7 #9
C7b9.....	SEVEN FLAT NINE.....	1 3 5 b7 b9
Cadd9.....	ADD NINE.....	1 3 5 9
C9.....	NINTH.....	1 3 5 b7 9
Cm9.....	MINOR NINE.....	1 b3 5 b7 9
Cmaj9.....	MAJOR NINE.....	1 3 5 7 9
Cm9maj7.....	MINOR NINE MAJOR SEVEN.....	1 b3 5 7 9
C9#5.....	NINE SHARP FIVE.....	1 3 #5 b7 9
C9b5.....	NINE FLAT FIVE.....	1 3 b5 b7 9
C11.....	ELEVENTH.....	1 (3) 5 b7 9 11
Cm11.....	MINOR ELEVENTH.....	1 b3 5 b7 9 11
C13.....	THIRTEENTH.....	1 3 5 b7 (9) (11) 13
Cm13.....	MINOR THIRTEENTH.....	1 b3 5 b7 (9) (11) 13
C13b9.....	THIRTEEN FLAT NINE.....	1 3 5 b7 b9 (11) 13
C13b5b9.....	THIRTEEN FLAT FIVE FLAT NINE.....	1 3 b5 b7 b9 (11) 13

THESE FORMULAS ARE ALL ON YOUR SLIDERULE. YOU CAN CONVERT ALL YOUR NUMBER PATTERNS INTO ALPHABET SPELLINGS USING IT.